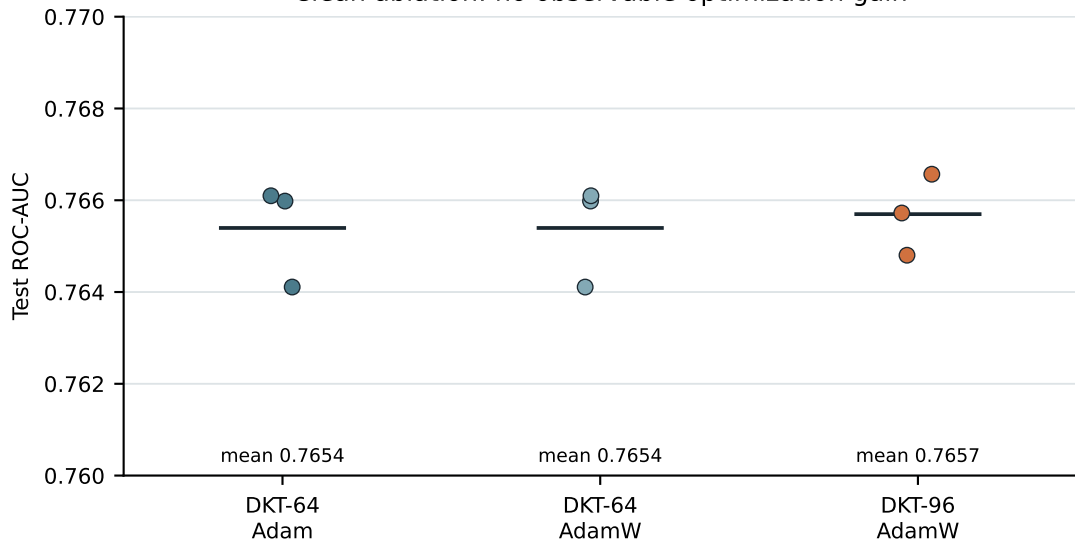


Clean ablation: no observable optimization gain



Identical 80/10/10 split, seed set, selection rule, and 8-epoch cap; horizontal bars denote means.

The y-axis is intentionally expanded only to reveal run-to-run variation, not a practically meaningful difference.